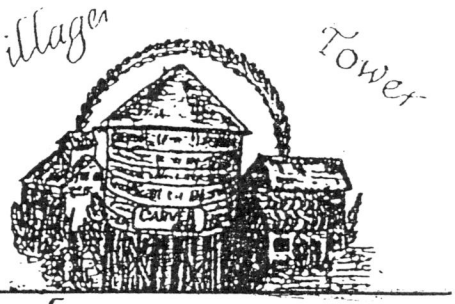
Volume XXIII
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Dedicated In Loving Memory of Ed Reed

Zoning Ordinance

The Planning Commission held a Public Hearing regarding the proposed revisions to the City of Carver's Zoning Ordinance in relation to bluffs, shore land management, steep slopes and natural resources. The group referenced the county's Bluff Area Study documents. The commissioners held lengthy discussions regarding the issue of reasonable allowances for structures in bluff setback areas. The Planning Commission members intentions with the ordinance was to preserve trees and vegetation not the removal of these. There have been a lot of complications involved in deck constructions.

Living Center

The Planning Commission listened to a presentation given by a representative from the Temporary Living Center organization. This organization is a non-profit agency offering adolescent females from the ages of thirteen to nineteen a safe and loving home like atmosphere to recover from substance abuse. The commissioners were informed that this was an informal presentation to make them aware of the desire to open a Temporary Living Center in the city. The City Planner would research the issue.

Fire Fighters Tribute

The council was approached concerning a proposed project to create a sculpture that would in turn serve as a tribute to the fire fighters. The presentation included estimated cost for this type of a project. Suggestion was submitted to create this tribute at the new Fire Station/Public Works building. The artist proposing the project would orchestrate the whole ordeal and these donations would fund this project.

Building Site

The council reviewed the status of a problematic building site . The attorney stated that the council had four options in which they could proceed. These options included Hazardous Building Act, Breach of Contract; Retention of Funds Pursuant upon Agreement or the Nuisance Proceeding. The attorney recommended the nuisance proceeding. The council discussed the complicated issue at length. Motion was made and carried directing that actions be taken to proceed with the Nuisance Ordinance. One neighbor was not satisfied with this decision. Forcing immediate construction completion was the decision wanted. The council was not anxious to become involved in a neighborhood dispute. The efforts being made to complete the construction are obvious.

Fire Fighters

The Fire Chief distributed information to the council from the NFPA which provided guidelines determining authorization of additional fire fighters. The Chief told the council that there should be a minimum of ten fire fighters responding within ten minutes of a fire call. Between the hours of 7 AM and 5 PM there is an average of nine fire fighters for a fire call. The department requested to increase the roster to thirty two fire fighters in order to be better prepared to handle daytime responses. Motion was made and carried with all ayes to increase the Fire Department roster from thirty to thirty two fire fighters.

Women's Organization

The Women's Organization is still in the developmental stages of a June Celebration for the city. Whatever these ladies organize we can be certain that it will be fun, artistic, creative, wonderful and dazzle everyone. Future developments will be printed in the newsletters to keep you all informed. So watch for news in the future.

And of course, all proceeds from their events will be given back to the community to benefit the historic parks of Carver.
Keep up the good work ladies!

Carver Youth Baseball/Softball Youth Association

Sign up for t-ball, baseball, softball and the like is just around the corner. It's sooner than you think! Wednesday, March 9th from 6 PM to 8 Pm at the Village Hall you will be able to start signing up to participate in what you like best. Then if you can't make it on Wednesday, you can schedule for Saturday the 12th from 9 AM to Noon, you can sign up again at the Village Hall. Mark your calendars.

PS. Late registrations will also be accepted. You can get late registrations from the city hall, forms are available from the staff. Contact city hall for those late registrations and pay fees to the city hall personnel.

Carver Lions

Well, let's see what are the Carver Lions up to? The usual. Busy planning, building, bettering (no such word, I know) making the community a better place, getting ready for their breakfast, Easter egg hunt for the munchkins, their upcoming pork chop dinner and of course, their own lives. Do you want to be a part of this fantastic busy bunch of people? You can check them out at the Village Hall meeting every month on the first and third Wednesday. They always welcome new members. It's fun, self gratifying and for such worthy causes. How better to become involved in the community you live in?

Watch future newsletters (city and the '*Villager Tower*') for upcoming information on the Lions Pork Chop Dinner scheduled for April 8th at the Village Hall from 5PM to 8PM.

Easter Bunny

The Easter Bunny, the Easter Bunny, the Easter Bunny is coming to Carver. Get those baskets ready, grab the lil' ones coats. It's time. The Easter Bunny is coming. There's 'gonna' be an Easter Egg Hunt. Hurry. Hurry. We can't go downtown mom, we 'gotta' go to the Community Park up there on Sixth Street by the new Fire Station. Come on Mom. Come on. We're 'gonna' miss him! I heard he's really fast. Com'on Mom The Easter Bunny's coming. Now that we got all the lil' munchkins' riled up for the Easter Egg Hunt, you can explain to Bobbie and Katie that they are too old to go with Mattie and Max to get eggs. Only kids to the age of 10 can participate in the egg hunt. The Easter Bunny isn't as spry as he used to be. He can't handle those older kids anymore. "Harvey" says 'sorry'. Maybe your brother or sister will share. That would be a good thing. So bring the lil' ones up to the Community Park on March 26th, Saturday at 10 AM and we'll have ourselves an Easter Egg Hunt and a whole bunch of fun. PS, if it rains, Harvey will put the eggs in the Village Hall. So bring your baskets and if you don't have a basket, just bring a bag, Harvey say's that will be okay too. See ya' there.

Did You Know?

...that in the 1870's Carver mason Henry Pintz traveled around performing such sundry tasks as plastering walls, building cellars, laying brick, building chimneys and constructing water cisterns? He came to Carver as an immigrant from Prussia in the German States.

...that the first resident physician to practice medicine in Carver was Dr Wm A Griffin who came to Carver in 1857. His first residence was probably located at the intersection of Fourth and Oak Streets.

....that on October 14th, 2856 a general election was held to determine a permanent Carver County Seat. The election to be decided was between Carver, Chaska, and San Francisco with Chaska receiving the majority of the 535 votes cast.

....that from 1854 until the 1890's the Carver levee was a bustling hub of commercial and industrial activity. Today the levee is vacant and separated from town by a flood dike.

...that in an 1889 *Carver Free Press* newspaper item the outspoken editor, Herman Muehlberg complained that the bridges over the creek in Carver were in such poor shape that horses were falling through them.

Comprehensive Plan Committee

The council was told that at the next Comprehensive Plan Committee Meeting that Tollefson was scheduled to present a master plan. Tentatively Heritage Development representatives could also be expected to attend. Suggestion was submitted that the school district representatives should be in attendance of these meetings as well.

Tollefson Development presented proposed plans defined as "West Carver Master Plan/City of Carver/Dahlgren Township" involving eleven hundred acres in the township. The consultants named for Tollefson are Acorn Environmental and Pioneer Engineering. The meeting agenda involved the conceptual master plan, committee discussions and future direction questions.

Background information was explained. This included the acreage involved in the Alternate Urban Area Review, a site location map had been provided and agreement had been drafted between the City of Carver and Dahlgren Township. These issues are the first steps towards the planning and development process. The Master Plan objectives included a comprehensive vision of the future; to plan community and neighborhoods, integrate land uses, cluster land uses in order to create more open space, identify environmental, physical and cultural features, identify goals and needs of the area, identify relationships with existing town center and development, plan transportation systems, greenway, open spaces, parks and trail connections, plan for pedestrians,; integrate land uses around core of system, land uses, residential life cycle housing, commercial, public needs, parks and green spaces, local and regional transit planning, and park and ride lots along with future bus service.

The Master Plan presented was of a traditional design with a mixture of land uses, along with open space, parks, and trails. The traffic circulation has been included in their reviewal processes, along with the Neighborhood Center and Public spaces. The housing ranged from starter homes to executive design homes targeted for all ages and income levels. The plan even included potentially constructing senior housing. The plan reviewed Open Space and Parks with a plan for a Central Park, Neighborhood Park, Gathering places, school and athletic complex, trails, green spaces and the Carver Creek. The plan reviewed traffic issues, as well. The master plan discussed a Neighborhood Center, mixed use multi story buildings, apartments, commercial day care centers, dentists, doctors, coffee shops, restaurants, pizza, fast food, video stores, and dry cleaners. These plans also included offices, community club house, senior center, water tower locations, test wells, public buildings, and a possible school location. The master plan addressed every conceivable type of housing imaginable from small to large lots and senior housing apartments with all different shapes, sizes and types.

The next step in this process involves finalizing the concept plans, completing the Alternate Urban Area Review , transportation studies, traffic studies, housing studies, senior housing needs, public needs, assessments of schools, public facilities, community center, future fire department needs, public utilities needs, schedule meetings with various involved governmental units such as the city, townships, school districts and the metropolitan council. These plans would also include future Comprehensive Plan workshop meetings.

Tollefson proceeded to expound that they "understood that this Master Plan is the beginning of the journey. That this is a great opportunity to create a special and unique community to enhance the city and the surrounding areas. That they will focus on identifying the goals and needs in order to create a unified vision. We may have different priorities, but could share a common vision. We desire to establish an ongoing working relationship to move this project forward addressing everyone's goals."

Tollefson continued to explain that of the 1100 proposed acreage that 2200 units would be built. These land uses would include condos with 80 units on 6 acres, row town homes on 144 acres with 898 units, no senior housing at present, 50' alley homes on 79 acres with 143 units, 66-70 foot wide single homes on 55 acres with 272 units, 80-90 foot wide single homes on 177 acres with 340 units, 95 foot wide executive lots on 210 acres with 317 units, 110 foot wide executive lots on 145 acres with 147 units, retail sites, civic/school on 28 acres, parks and open space on 265 acres, totaling 1115 acres. Total units would be 2197 units.

The question was asked why they weren't using more units per acres so as not to require so much farm property to be included in the project. This would be checked into. Access to present county roads was questioned. Access would remain unchanged for Maplewood road connecting to County Road #43. Accesses on Mt Carmel Road were reviewed. It is Tollefson goal to complete the Alternate Urban Area Review study by June of 2006 with the hopes of starting their project in the year 2008 if approvals are in place at that time. The next Comprehensive Plan Committee meeting is scheduled for March 28th.

Carver Fire Department Highlights and Community Calendar

March 2005

March 1st - Woman's Organization Meeting
March 2nd - Happy Birthday Cindy!
Happy Birthday Sunny!
March 3rd - Drill Night 6:30 PM
Happy 150th Birthday – Carver County
March 4th - No School – Work Shop
March 5th - Happy Birthday Karen!
March 7th - Council Meeting
March 8th - Township Elections
Annual Township Meeting
March 10th - Happy Birthday Sandy!
March 13th - Lions Pancake/French Toast Breakfast
Happy Birthday Andrea!
March 14th - Park and Recreation Board
Dahlgren Township Board Meeting
March 15th - Heritage Preservation Commission
March 17th - St Patrick's Day
March 18th - Black Sox Ham and Turkey Bingo
March 20th - First Day of Spring
Palm Sunday
March 21st - Council Meeting
Drill Night 6:30 PM
March 22nd - Planning Commission
March 24th through April 1st
No School – Spring Break
Happy Birthday Keith!
March 25th - Good Friday
Happy Birthday Bette!
March 26th - Easter Egg Hunt
Happy Birthday Beth!
Happy Birthday James!
March 27th - Easter Sunday
March 28th - Comprehensive Plan Group Meeting
March 30th - Happy Birthday Paul!
March 31st - Fire Department Meeting

April

April 8th - Lions Pork Chop Dinner
April 11th - Township Board of Review Meeting

Disclaimer

The 'unapproved' minutes of the council and the township meetings have been referenced for the purposes of reporting news in the "*Villager Tower*" and creating the contents of this newsletter for the purpose of informing residents in the City of Carver and the townships surrounding the city.

Truths Children Have Learned:

No matter how hard you try you can't baptize cats.

When you mom is mad at your Dad, don't let her brush your hair.

You can't hide a piece of broccoli in a glass of milk.

Puppies still have bad breath even after eating a Tic-Tac.

Truths Adults have Learned:

Middle age is when you choose cereal for fiber, not the toy.

If you can remain calm, you don't have all the facts.

You are getting old when you stoop to tie your shoes and wonder what else you can do while you're down there.

Did You Know?

...that many of Carver's early sidewalks, especially on Broadway, were dock-like boardwalks and that the streets were lined with wooden hitching posts for horses and horse drawn wagons.

....that in 1894 Carver's population was 700.

...that in 1878 Carver's first shade trees were planted in front of the Planter's Hotel by its proprietor, Charles A Bloomquist.

Strategic Planning Work Session

The city council, city staff, and consultants conducted a strategic planning work session to plan for the city.

The city attorney began the work session with an update on the city's wastewater treatment plant capacity and the Metropolitan Council's involvement. The capability of the plant is for the approximate population of thirty three hundred. The city could invest approximately one hundred fifty thousand dollars to accommodate a population of four thousand. A one million dollar investment would serve up to six thousand people but an Environmental Assessment Worksheet would be necessary. Also, it was noted that this million dollars investment did not include the design. The design would be an additional twenty to thirty thousand dollars. It was further stated that this investment would require significant permits and it was not certain that these permits would even be granted to the city.

The city planner interjected that only the Heritage Phase II development would be discharged into the current wastewater treatment plant. It was the attorney's opinion that the Met Council be asked to secure this plant by the council. The city would be able to negotiate with the Met Council. The attorney proceeded to explain that the State Statutes require the Met Council to take over the debt of the plant and must purchase the plant from the city. However, the Met Council would depreciate the plant and would not pay any land value while issuing the city an IOU. Ultimately the city would receive payment but there would not be a definite time schedule of receipt. Additionally an interceptor would also be required to be constructed from the plant to the MUSA(Metropolitan Urban Services Area) line. There was debate whether or not the Met Council would pay for this line.

Then there was the discussion regarding the Met Council reclassification process and the possibility of the city being reclassified. If this reclassification occurs the city could then be required to dismantle the wastewater treatment plant. Currently the city is classified as a rural center. Reclassification could mean the city being defined as a developing center. Furthermore, if the city delays, it would then become difficult to annex some of the land that the city is interested in procuring. Land density is a priority with the Met Council. The Met Council prefers high land density. The city attorney pointed out that this could mean that the Met Council could want the City of Carver to grow more than the city envisions. The attorney pointed out further that areas that cannot be developed, such as bluff land, could consequently require higher density on flat lands. Suggestion was submitted to extend an invitation to the Metropolitan Council representative to attend the council meeting to discuss these issues.

Information from the 1993 Work shop regarding strategic planning was reviewed. The Mission Statement was discussed. It was the council's consensus to involve the public. Changes would be drafted. It was the council's consensus upon approval of the Mission Statement that this statement should be published on the city's website, as well as in the city's newsletter.

Further discussion was held regarding the viewpoints envisioned for the future of the city and the importance of the various projects and positions of plans. All of this input would be compiled and the city planner will bring these ideas back to the council for further discussions and actions.

Black Sox Ham and Turkey Bingo

The Black Sox are at it again. Do you like Ham and Turkey? Come and have some. Or maybe the winners at Bingo get a ham or turkey? Do you know? Isn't that a rotten shame, I don't know. Couldn't be 'cuz' I don't like Bingo could it? Sorry guys. No, you are served ham or turkey (I think) and you get to play Bingo. "GOTCHA". I got you to read this now didn't I? Come to the Village Hall on March 18th for some food, beverages, good company and some bingo. The bingo cards are a quarter a piece. (have you ever noticed when working on a computer you cannot print the cent sign for twenty five cents?) "gotcha again". You can play bingo from 7 PM to 11 PM. Don't think I forgot anything, so there you are. See you at Bingo.

Lions Pancake/French Toast Breakfast

Hey Edna. That Lions Pancake/French Toast Breakfast advertised, is that where they have those delicious sausages Edna? Let's go. When is it? Where is it? Is that where they check that diabetes thing too? Come on Edna, let's get going. Herb, we can't go until Sunday the 13th at the Carver Village Hall. They will start serving at 7:30 AM. We can buy our tickets early and get them for $4. If we wait until that Sunday, then it's $6. We could bring Susie and she can eat for $2 because she's twelve. It says here that 6 to 12 is $2. Children under six are free, so we could also stop and pick up Tammy and Tommie. How late are they serving? They will be serving pancakes, french toast and that homemade sausage until 1 PM. Edna, who do we buy them tickets from before the 13th? Says here we can go to city hall or we can contact any Lions member. Oh Herb, look, it says here that we can buy the ticket drawn for a $100 Savings Bond. That's it Edna, get your coat, we're going to Ken's house and we're buying tickets, we'll take all the grandchildren to breakfast.

So there, you go, you want to see Edna and Herb and all their ten grandchildren, you better get over to the Village Hall on the 13th of March, that would be Sunday from 7:30 AM to 1 PM. Be sure to stop and say 'hey' to Mr and Mrs Herbert Imagination when you are there.

Carver County Turns 150

By: John von Walter

March marks 150 years since Carver County was created by the Minnesota Territorial Legislature. On March 3, 1855 Carver County was carved out of a once much larger Hennepin County, and three county board members were appointed by Territorial Governor Willis Gorman, their terms to last until November of that year when an election could be held for the positions. The Sesquicentennial was commemorated on March 3, 2005 in a celebration at the Carver County Government Center. The Sheriff's Mounted Posse delivered a proclamation to the county board that was signed by Governor Tim Pawlenty. Present for the county's "birthday party" were several people from Carver, including Carver County Attorney Mike Fahey, and from the Carver City Council, Mayor Jim Weygand and Councilor Cindy Monroe. Sesquicentennial celebrations will take place throughout the year, so for those who missed the initial March 3 activities there will be much more to follow.

March 5th marks another 150th anniversary. On March 5, 1855, Carver's Levi Griffin was appointed the first Sheriff of Carver County by Territorial Governor Gorman. Griffin was one of the original members of the Carver Land Company, which purchased and platted the Town of Carver. In 1854 Griffin was the first member of the Carver Land Company to take up residence in Carver. He became Carver's first stagecoach line owner, operated the first river ferry in Carver, built and operated the Carver House Hotel, and was later a U. S. Marshall. Levi Griffin's wife, Eliza, was the first White woman in Carver. Their daughter, also named Eliza, born May 29, 1855, was the first White child born in Carver. Levi Griffin and his family lived on Fourth Street East in Carver. Griffin's Carver House Hotel, later called the Planter's Hotel, no longer stands. It stood on Broadway on the site of the present day Carver Gazebo Park.

Another Beatitude

By: Elizabeth Clark

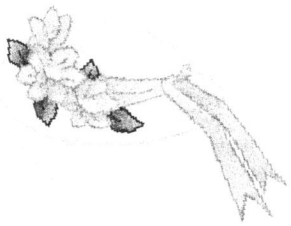
Blessed are they who understand my faltering
step and shaking hand.
Blessed are they who know my ears today must
strain to catch the things they say.
Blessed are they who seem to know my eyes
are dim and my mind is slow
Blessed are they who looked away, when I
spilled my tea on the cloth that day.
Blessed are they who, with cheery smile,
stopped to chat for a little while.
Blessed are they who know the way to bring
back memories of yesterday.
Blessed are they who never say, "you've told
that story twice today."
Blessed are they who make it know that I'm
loved, respected and not alone.
And Blessed are they who will ease the days of
my journey home, in loving way.

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